

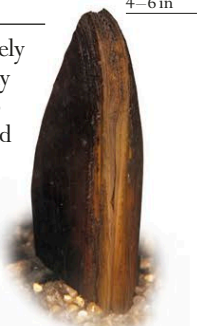
FRESHWATER MUSSELS

The Unionoida are the only exclusively freshwater order of bivalves. The tiny larvae use their valves to clamp onto fish, forming cysts on the gill fins and feeding on blood or mucus before dropping off as juvenile mussels.



SWAN MUSSEL
Anodonta sp.
F: Unionidae

Bitterling fish lay eggs in living freshwater mussels, such as this Eurasian species. The mollusk becomes a nursery for fish fry.



FRESHWATER PEARL MUSSEL
Pinctada margaritifera
F: Margaritiferidae
Well known for its good-quality pearls, this mussel lives buried in sand or gravel beneath fast-flowing rivers in Eurasia and N. America.

TRUE CLAMS AND BORING BIVALVES

Long-siphoned bivalves in the order Myoida typically burrow in mud or bore through wood or rock. In piddocks the front of the shell acts like a file to bore burrows in soft rock. Shipworms use their shell valves to drill through timber.



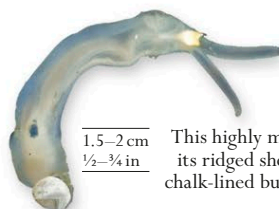
COMMON PIDDOCK
Pholas dactylus
F: Pholadidae

This common piddock of the N.E. Atlantic is phosphorescent and, like other species, lives in burrows bored in wood or clay.



SOFT SHELL CLAM
Mya arenaria
F: Myidae

An edible clam with a thin shell, this N. Atlantic species is especially abundant in muddy estuaries, where it burrows in soft sediment.



SHIPWORM
Teredo navalis
F: Teredinidae

This highly modified, widespread bivalve uses its ridged shell valves as a drill to bore deep, chalk-lined burrows in timber, damaging ships.

WATERING POTS AND RELATIVES

The order Pholadomyoida includes clams and tropical watering pots. Scarcely recognizable as bivalves, watering pots live encased in chalky tubes, and draw detritus and water into the tube through a perforated plate at the anterior end.

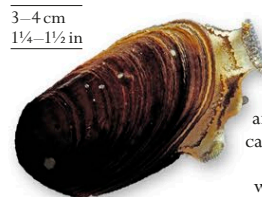
PHILIPPINE WATERING POT
Verpa philippinensis
F: Penicillidae

This bizarre Indo-Pacific watering pot belongs to a family named for their wide, perforated ends, fringed with tubules. It lives partially buried in sediment.



COCKLES AND RELATIVES

The largest order of bivalves, the Veneroida include a large range of marine animals. Most have short siphons that are often fused together. Some, notably the cockles, are agile, capable of burrowing or even leaping with their foot. Others are attached to rocks by a byssus.

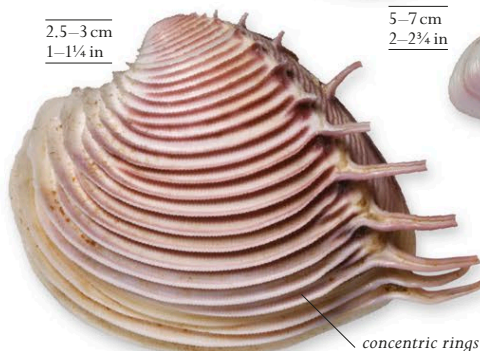


ZEBRA MUSSEL
Dreissena polymorpha
F: Dreissenidae

This freshwater mussel is anchored by byssus threads, but can detach and crawl on a slender foot. Native to E. European waters, it has spread elsewhere.

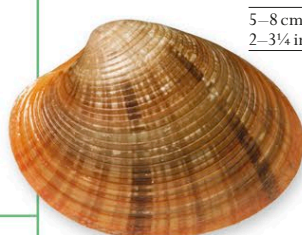
COMMON EDIBLE COCKLE
Cerastoderma edule
F: Cardiidae

Sand-burrowing cockles have a shell with radiating ribs. This N.E. Atlantic species, often found in vast numbers, is fished in N. Europe.



ROYAL COMB VENUS
Hysteroconcha dione
F: Veneridae

Named after the comb-like spines on its shell, this Venus clam occurs on tropical American coastlines.



RED CALLISTA
Callista erycina
F: Veneridae

Many Venus clams are prized by collectors, including this Indo-Pacific species, also known as the sunset clam.



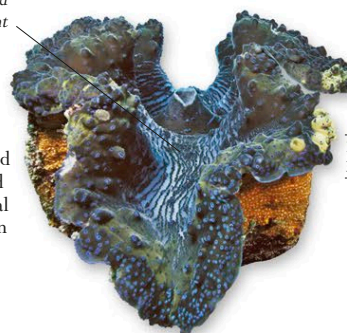
RINGED DOSINIA
Dosinia anus
F: Veneridae

This Venus clam is found on the coastlines of New Zealand, and is one of many species harvested for human consumption.

algae within mantle exposed to sunlight

GIANT CLAM
Tridacna gigas
F: Cardiidae

The world's largest bivalve, this long-lived and now endangered coral-dwelling animal lives on sandy beds in the Indo-Pacific.



SWORD RAZOR CLAM
Ensis siliqua
F: Pharidae

Razor shells, such as this N.E. Atlantic species, live in burrows, feeding and respiring through their emergent siphon, but drop quickly using their muscular foot when disturbed.



CRADLE DONAX
Donax cuneatus
F: Donacidae

One of a family of triangular wedge shells that are fast burrowers in surf, this is a tropical Indo-Pacific species.



OBLONG TRAPEZIUM
Trapezium oblongum
F: Trapezidae

An Indo-Pacific bivalve, this animal lives attached to rocks by byssus threads, usually in crevices or beneath coral rubble.



SUNRISE TELLIN
Tellina radiata
F: Tellinidae

The shell of this tellin from the Caribbean has a variable banding pattern and is often found on beaches.

WEST AFRICAN TELLIN
Peronaea madagascariensis
F: Tellinidae

Tellins, such as this rose-coloured tropical species, feed on particles in sediment, drawn in through their long, extendable siphon.

STRIPED TELLIN
Tellinella virgata
F: Tellinidae

This Indo-Pacific species has a decoratively patterned shell, as do many tellins.



FLUTED GIANT CLAM
Tridacna squamosa
F: Cardiidae

large, scale-like flutes

Like other Indo-Pacific giant clams, this species opens its shell during the day so that algae in its coloured mantle can photosynthesize to make food.

